

UI/UX Design Roadmap

Beginner → UI Designer → UX Designer → Product Designer
UI Design-UX Research-Figma-Wireframing-Prototyping-Design Systems-Portfolio

Phase 1: Design Fundamentals

Learn the core principles of visual design and how users perceive and interact with digital products.

Why learn it?

Strong design fundamentals help create products that are both visually appealing and easy to use.

Topics to Learn:

1. Contrast
2. Alignment
3. Repetition
4. Proximity
5. Balance
6. White Space
7. Colour Theory
8. Typography
9. Layout & Composition
10. Visual Hierarchy
11. Gestalt Principles
12. Empathize
13. Define
14. Ideate
15. Prototype
16. Test

Practice:

Analyse popular websites and mobile apps, recreate simple UI screens, and compare good and bad design examples to understand design principles in action.

Goal

Build a strong foundation in visual design and design thinking. By completing this phase, you should be able to:

1.  Understand design fundamentals
2.  Create visually balanced layouts
3.  Apply design thinking principles
4.  Evaluate user-friendly interfaces

Outcome:

You will understand the core principles of design and be able to create visually appealing, structured, and user-focused interfaces.



Phase 2: UI Design Basics

UI (User Interface) Design focuses on designing the visual elements users interact with in websites, mobile apps, and software products.

Why learn it?

Every digital product needs intuitive and attractive interfaces that help users complete tasks efficiently and enjoyably.

Topics to Learn:

1. Buttons
2. Forms
3. Input Fields
4. Cards
5. Modals
6. Navigation Menus
7. Icons
8. Mobile UI Patterns
9. Web UI Patterns
10. Dashboard Design
11. Figma
12. Penpot

Practice:

Create a Login Page, Registration Page, Landing Page, and Dashboard Interface using modern UI design principles.

Goal

Design attractive and functional interfaces using modern UI patterns and industry-standard tools. By completing this phase, you should be able to:

1.  Design professional user interfaces
2.  Create reusable UI components
3.  Apply modern design patterns
4.  Build web and mobile interface layouts
5.  Use Figma and Penpot effectively

Outcome:

You will be able to design visually appealing and user-friendly interfaces that follow modern UI standards and best practices.



Phase 3: UX Fundamentals

UX (User Experience) focuses on understanding users, their needs, behaviours, and challenges to create products that provide meaningful and efficient experiences.

Why learn it?

Beautiful designs fail if users cannot achieve their goals efficiently. UX helps create products that are useful, usable, and enjoyable.

Topics to Learn:

1. User Interviews
2. Surveys
3. Competitive Analysis
4. User Personas
5. Empathy Maps
6. User Stories
7. User Journey Mapping
8. Information Architecture
9. Usability Principles

Practice:

Study how users interact with websites and mobile apps. Observe user behaviour, identify pain points, and suggest improvements to enhance the overall experience.

Goal

Understand user needs, pain points, and behaviour to create user-centered digital experiences. By completing this phase, you should be able to:

1.  Conduct basic UX research
2.  Create user personas and empathy maps
3.  Analyse user journeys and workflows
4.  Improve usability and user satisfaction
5.  Make design decisions based on user needs

Outcome:

You will be able to understand users better, identify usability issues, and design experiences that help users achieve their goals effectively.



Phase 4: Wireframing & User Flows

Wireframing and User Flows help designers plan the structure, layout, and navigation of a product before creating detailed visual designs.

Why learn it?

Wireframes help validate ideas quickly, reduce design errors, and ensure users can navigate products efficiently before investing time in high-fidelity designs.

Topics to Learn:

1. Low-Fidelity Wireframes
2. Mid-Fidelity Wireframes
3. High-Fidelity Wireframes
4. User Tasks
5. Navigation Flows
6. Journey Mapping
7. Information Structure
8. User Flow Diagrams

Practice:

Create wireframes and user flows for a Food Delivery App, E-commerce Website, and Job Portal to understand how users move through digital products.

Goal

Transform business requirements into structured user experiences and navigation systems. By completing this phase, you should be able to:

1.  Create effective wireframes for digital products
2.  Design clear user journeys and navigation paths
3.  Organize information logically
4.  Validate product ideas before visual design
5.  Improve user experience through structured planning

Outcome:

You will be able to convert ideas and requirements into organized wireframes and user flows that serve as the foundation for successful product design.



Phase 5: Figma Mastery

Figma is the industry-standard design and collaboration tool used to create, prototype, and hand off digital product designs.

Why learn it?

Most startups and enterprises use Figma for UI/UX design workflows, team collaboration, prototyping, and developer handoff.

Topics to Learn:

1. Frames
2. Constraints
3. Components
4. Variants
5. Auto Layout
6. Variables
7. Design Libraries
8. Prototyping
9. Dev Mode
10. Team Libraries
11. Comments
12. Design Handoff

Practice:

Design complete web and mobile applications in Figma, create reusable components, build prototypes, and collaborate with team members.

Goal

Work confidently with professional design workflows and industry-standard tools. By completing this phase, you should be able to:

1.  Create professional UI designs in Figma
2.  Build reusable components and design systems
3.  Create interactive prototypes
4.  Collaborate effectively with designers and developers
5.  Prepare designs for developer handoff

Outcome:

You will be able to use Figma efficiently to design, prototype, collaborate, and deliver professional-quality UI/UX projects.



Phase 6: Responsive Design & Accessibility

Responsive Design and Accessibility focus on creating digital experiences that work seamlessly across different devices and can be used by people with diverse abilities.

Why learn it?

Accessibility and responsive design are essential industry requirements that ensure products reach a wider audience and provide a consistent user experience across all devices.

Topics to Learn:

1. Mobile-First Design
2. Grid Systems
3. Breakpoints
4. Adaptive Layouts
5. Color Contrast
6. Keyboard Navigation
7. Screen Readers
8. Accessible Forms
9. WCAG Guidelines

Practice:

Design a Mobile App, Tablet Interface, and Desktop Dashboard while ensuring responsiveness, accessibility, and usability across all screen sizes.

Goal

Create inclusive and responsive designs that provide excellent user experiences on all devices. By completing this phase, you should be able to:

-  Design interfaces for multiple screen sizes
-  Apply responsive design principles effectively
-  Follow accessibility best practices
-  Create inclusive user experiences
-  Meet modern accessibility standards and guidelines

Outcome:

You will be able to design products that are accessible, user-friendly, and optimized for mobile, tablet, and desktop users alike.



Phase 7: Design Systems

A Design System is a collection of reusable components, guidelines, and standards that ensure consistency across products, teams, and platforms.

Why learn it?

Large companies rely on design systems to maintain consistency, improve collaboration, reduce design debt, and speed up product development.

Topics to Learn:

1. Design Tokens
2. Component Libraries
3. Naming Conventions
4. Colors
5. Typography
6. Icons
7. Spacing Systems
8. Material Design
9. Apple Human Interface Guidelines
10. Brand Consistency

Practice:

Build your own design system in Figma, including reusable components, color palettes, typography scales, and documentation guidelines.

Goal

Create scalable and reusable design frameworks that improve consistency and efficiency across products. By completing this phase, you should be able to:

1.  Build reusable UI component libraries
2.  Create and manage design tokens
3.  Establish design standards and guidelines
4.  Maintain consistency across multiple products
5.  Collaborate efficiently with design and development teams

Outcome:

You will be able to create, maintain, and scale design systems that support efficient product development and consistent user experiences.



Phase 8: AI for Designers

AI for Designers focuses on using artificial intelligence tools to enhance design research, ideation, content creation, prototyping, and overall design productivity.

Why learn it?

AI-assisted workflows are becoming a standard part of modern design teams, helping designers work faster while focusing more on creativity, problem-solving, and user experience.

Topics to Learn:

1. Figma AI Features
2. ChatGPT for UX Research
3. AI Wireframe Generation
4. AI Content Generation
5. User Research Summaries
6. Design Ideation
7. UX Writing
8. Rapid Prototyping
9. AI-Assisted Design Workflows

Practice:

Use AI tools to generate design concepts, improve user flows, create content suggestions, summarize research findings, and accelerate prototyping workflows.

Goal

Leverage AI to improve productivity and accelerate design workflows without replacing human creativity and design thinking. By completing this phase, you should be able to:

1. ☒ Use AI tools to support design research
2. ☒ Generate ideas and concepts more efficiently
3. ☒ Create wireframes and prototypes faster
4. ☒ Improve UX writing and content creation
5. ☒ Integrate AI into professional design workflows

Outcome:

You will be able to use AI as a powerful design assistant, helping you work more efficiently while maintaining strong user-centered design practices.

** Phase 9: Portfolio & Real Projects**

A strong portfolio showcases your design skills, problem-solving abilities, and design process through real-world projects and case studies.

Why learn it?

Recruiters and hiring managers evaluate your portfolio to understand your design thinking, creativity, and ability to solve user problems effectively.

Topics to Learn:

1. Login Flow Design
2. Landing Page Design
3. Personal Portfolio Website
4. Food Delivery App
5. Expense Tracker App
6. Fitness Application
7. Banking Application
8. Healthcare Platform
9. Learning Management System
10. Travel Booking Platform
11. Job Portal

12. Problem Statement Documentation
13. User Research
14. Wireframes
15. Final Design Presentation
16. Design Decisions
17. Outcome Analysis

Practice:

Complete multiple end-to-end UI/UX projects and document the entire design process from research and wireframing to final design and outcomes.

Goal

Build a portfolio that demonstrates real-world design skills and showcases your ability to solve user problems effectively. By completing this phase, you should be able to:

1.  Create professional UI/UX case studies
2.  Showcase end-to-end design projects
3.  Present your design process clearly
4.  Demonstrate problem-solving skills
5.  Build a portfolio that attracts recruiters and hiring managers

Outcome:

You will have an industry-ready portfolio that highlights your design expertise, creativity, and ability to deliver user-centered solutions.



Phase 10: Job Preparation

Job preparation focuses on building a professional profile, preparing for interviews, and showcasing your design skills effectively to potential employers.

Why learn it?

Strong design skills alone are not enough. You also need a compelling portfolio, professional presence, and interview readiness to secure UI/UX design roles.

Topics to Learn:

1. One-Page Resume
2. ATS-Friendly Format

3. Professional LinkedIn Headline
4. Portfolio Links
5. Case Studies
6. Design Principles
7. Typography
8. Color Theory
9. UX Research Methods
10. User Flows
11. Accessibility
12. Whiteboard Challenges
13. App Redesign Exercises
14. Product Design Exercises
15. LinkedIn
16. Behance
17. Dribbble
18. Foundit
19. Naukri
20. NextGenZ.careers

Practice:

Create a professional resume, optimize your LinkedIn profile, publish your portfolio, practice design challenges, and participate in mock interviews.

Goal

Become interview-ready and secure your first UI/UX design role. By completing this phase, you should be able to:

1. ☒ Create a professional design resume
2. ☒ Build a strong online presence and portfolio
3. ☒ Present design decisions confidently
4. ☒ Solve design challenges during interviews
5. ☒ Apply effectively for UI/UX and Product Design opportunities

Outcome:

You will be fully prepared to apply for and succeed in interviews for UI Designer, UX Designer, Product Designer, and UX Researcher roles.

Final Outcome

By completing this roadmap, you will:

1. ☒ Design professional web and mobile interfaces
2. ☒ Conduct UX research and usability analysis
3. ☒ Create wireframes and interactive prototypes

4. ☒ Build responsive and accessible designs
5. ☒ Create and maintain design systems
6. ☒ Use AI tools effectively in the design process
7. ☒ Build an industry-ready portfolio
8. ☒ Become job-ready for UI Designer, UX Designer, Product Designer, and UX Researcher roles in 2026

Outcome:

You will possess the design knowledge, practical experience, portfolio projects, and professional skills needed to build a successful career in UI/UX and Product Design.